



T-Mobile won't sell Fold

T-Mobile won't be carrying the Samsung Galaxy Fold even though they planned to before the recall. <https://dgit.in/aug19-75>



Xiaomi #1 smartphone brand

Xiaomi is the number one smartphone brand in India in Q2 of 2019, taking the position from Samsung. <https://dgit.in/azug19-76>

Acer Swift 3 SF313-51

A thin and light model with 4G LTE connectivity

Acer believes that everyday consumer laptops can feature 4G LTE connectivity. Enter the Acer Swift 3. Let's see how it did.

Build and Design

The body of the Swift 3 is made of aluminium. The laptop's metal silver chassis is fairly sturdy and easy to grip in the hands. The laptop's power brick is compact and lightweight.

The push of one finger is all it takes to open the display all the way from zero to a comfortable 180 degrees. When pushed and pulled with one hand, the display unit reveals little sign of flex. Some flex, however, is observed on the keyboard island when the keys are tapped hard. In the one a silver colour option that the laptop is available in, the Acer Swift 3 ends up looking a bit plain Jane.



Price
₹58,990



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However, in GPU benchmark tests, the Acer caught up. On 3DMark's Cloud Gate and Sky Diver, the review unit bagged 3768 and 3582. In everyday scenarios, the review unit performed as smoothly as we'd anticipated, with multitasking being smooth and fluid.

Gaming was understandably a strained experience on the Swift 3. It can take on less demanding titles with some effort, such as Ori and the Blind Forest and Portal. But it cannot be considered seriously for playing games.

The "-51" variant of the Swift 3 comes with inbuilt 4G LTE connectivity, which, when set up, is meant to liberate the laptop from the Wi-Fi network. Users with an active data plan should in theory be able to use their laptop on the go without depending on hotspot networks or coffee shops that offer free Wi-Fi.

Keyboard and touchpad

The keyboard is probably the Swift 3's weakest element. The keycaps are too tiny for a laptop of its size, which leads to frequent mistypes and stress on the fingertips. We wish the power button weren't placed adjacent to the Delete key as a press of the wrong key can lead to unintended Sleeps and Hibernates. On the plus side, the keys have a decent amount of travel and resistance. However, this keyboard is not for users

who do a lot of typing. The touchpad, on the other hand, is a precision unit, which means that multi-finger taps and swipes can be performed without installing any third-party drivers or utilities. Windows 10 also allows users to reprogramme these functions right within Settings.

The two mouse buttons beneath the surface of the touchpad are fairly easy to click. The surface area of the touchpad too is sufficient for everyday use.

Battery

The Swift 3 ships with a Quad-cell lithium-ion battery with a capacity of 3320mAh. Acer claims that this unit is enough to make the laptop last for up to 12 hours on a single full charge. On our standard battery benchmark test, the review unit lasted 4 hours, 37 minutes, which is quite a decent figure. In comparison, the similarly priced Asus VivoBook S14, lasted 3 hours, 8 minutes on the same test. The costlier Asus ZenBook 13, on the other hand, scored 5 hours, 20 minutes on the same test. In everyday scenarios, the review unit lost close to 40 percent of its charge in a little over an hour's time.

Acer Swift 3 SF313-51 Verdict

The thin and light Acer Swift 3 certainly makes a case for itself by offering what others don't, that is 4G LTE connectivity. It's what makes the Swift 3 an ideal choice for those who want a laptop that is truly "on the go" without relying on dongles and hotspot networks. Sadly, the bundled Ubiquiti internet service is a let down as getting it to work is a hassle. The Acer Swift 3 is still a good laptop even if we don't count its big party trick. It features a crisp display that's mostly colour-accurate and free of glare. It's a laptop you can't really go wrong with.

—Vignesh Girdharan

Display, audio and IO

The Swift 3 features a 13.3-inch IPS LCD screen with a Full HD resolution. Content looks crisp and clear and colours seem to be fairly accurate too.

Sound from the laptop's two speakers is underwhelming. Songs like The Weeknd's Starboy sound bland across low, mid, and high frequencies. These speakers are best reserved for error and warning sounds from Windows.

On the left of the Swift 3, we see a proprietary round-pin power port, USB-A 2.0 port, a 3.5mm audio jack, and a card tray for a microSD card and nano SIM. On the right side, we see a USB-A 3.0 slot, a full-size HDMI port, a USB-C 3.0 port, and a Kensington lock slot.

Performance and gaming

The review unit's performance in our CPU benchmark tests was underwhelming. On PCMark 8's Accelerated Creative test, the laptop scored 3371.

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: Intel Core i5-8250U | RAM: 16GB | SSD: up to 512GB SSD | GPU: Intel UHD Graphics 620 | DISPLAY: 13.3" | RESOLUTION: Full HD (1920 x 1080) | IO: 1x USB Type-C 3.0 (3.1 Gen 1), 1x USB Type-A 3.0 (3.1 Gen 1), 1x USB Type-A 2.0 | WEIGHT: 1.35 kg | BATTERY: 3320 mAh

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